

Superstorm Sandy Recovery Support Environmental Reviews

Background

In October 2012, Superstorm Sandy ravaged the Northeast, becoming the second-costliest hurricane in U.S. history. Upwards of 56,000 residential properties sustained severe damage and the state of New Jersey experienced approximately \$382 million in private commercial property loss and almost \$64 million in business interruption. Infrastructure damage was estimated at a cost of more than \$250 billion.

As part of the federal government's response, the state of New Jersey was awarded \$5.4 billion in aid appropriated through the Community Development Block Grant (CDBG)-Disaster Relief program of the U.S. Department of Housing and Urban Development. To enable the distribution of federal grant monies, the state of New Jersey was required to address National Environmental Policy Act (NEPA) compliance for each project application under the CDBG program.

Scope

Gannett Fleming was awarded a 3-year contract with the New Jersey Department of Environmental Protection to complete the required environmental reviews. Environmental compliance reviews under the Sandy Recovery CDBG program involve resource assessments that address: air quality, the Coastal Area Facility Review Act, Endangered Species Act review, community effects, floodplain impacts, Section 106 compliance, and wetlands and surface water impacts.

In addition to reviews of residential and commercial properties, our firm was tasked with the review of notable and complex infrastructure projects. These efforts included the review of a dune protection project, reconstruction of a damaged community park, renovation of a critical municipal emergency operations facility, and the review of economic revitalization projects that involved streetscape improvements.



Rehabilitation and elevation of a residence damaged during Superstorm Sandy

Client

New Jersey Department of Environmental Protection

Location

Various Coastal Counties in New Jersey

Firm's Fee

\$1.8 Million

Accomplishments

Since September of 2013, we have completed more than 100 task order assignments, involving more than 600 Tier II environmental reviews; 30 Categorical Exclusions; and 15 Environmental Assessments to meet NEPA compliance for the grant program.

Aggressive schedules and the quality objectives of the program have been met, while working under evolving state program management and review procedures.